

Aligning AI Tools with Trillium Workflows: Evaluation of SETWorks AI and Copilot

Trillium – Empower3

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Team Introduction & Project Background

Our Team Members



Partnering with Trillium

Trillium, a Washington-based nonprofit, empowers individuals with developmental disabilities through inclusive employment.

The Core Problem

As services expand, so does the administrative workload (documenting services, managing schedules, and preparing required reports). Trillium seeks AI tools to reduce administrative burden, allowing staff to focus on direct client support.

Why This Matters

Improving administrative efficiency directly impacts:

- Quality of client support
- Staff workload and burnout prevention
- Scalability and sustainability of Trillium's mission



Project Journey: Initial Goals & Methods

Initial Goals & Scope

At the start, our objectives were clear:

- **Identify workflow pain points**
Understand which tasks take the most time across staff roles
- **Compare AI tools**
Evaluate usability, accuracy, integration fit, and practical value
- **Develop an AI adoption plan**
Provide a realistic and scalable path suitable for a nonprofit setting

How We Approached the Problem

- **Staff Interviews**
Uncovered daily challenges and validated real-world workflow experiences
- **Workflow Mapping**
Visualized core processes to pinpoint specific bottlenecks
- **Usage Survey**
Collected quantitative and qualitative data on current digital habits
- **Solution Assessment**
Evaluated tools based on features, limitations, and alignment with Trillium's needs

Project Evolution

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Initial Assumptions

- Full understanding of end-to-end business processes.
- Access to data and document samples.
- Plan to use testing tools to create concrete.
- Hands-on tutorial videos for AI tool usage.

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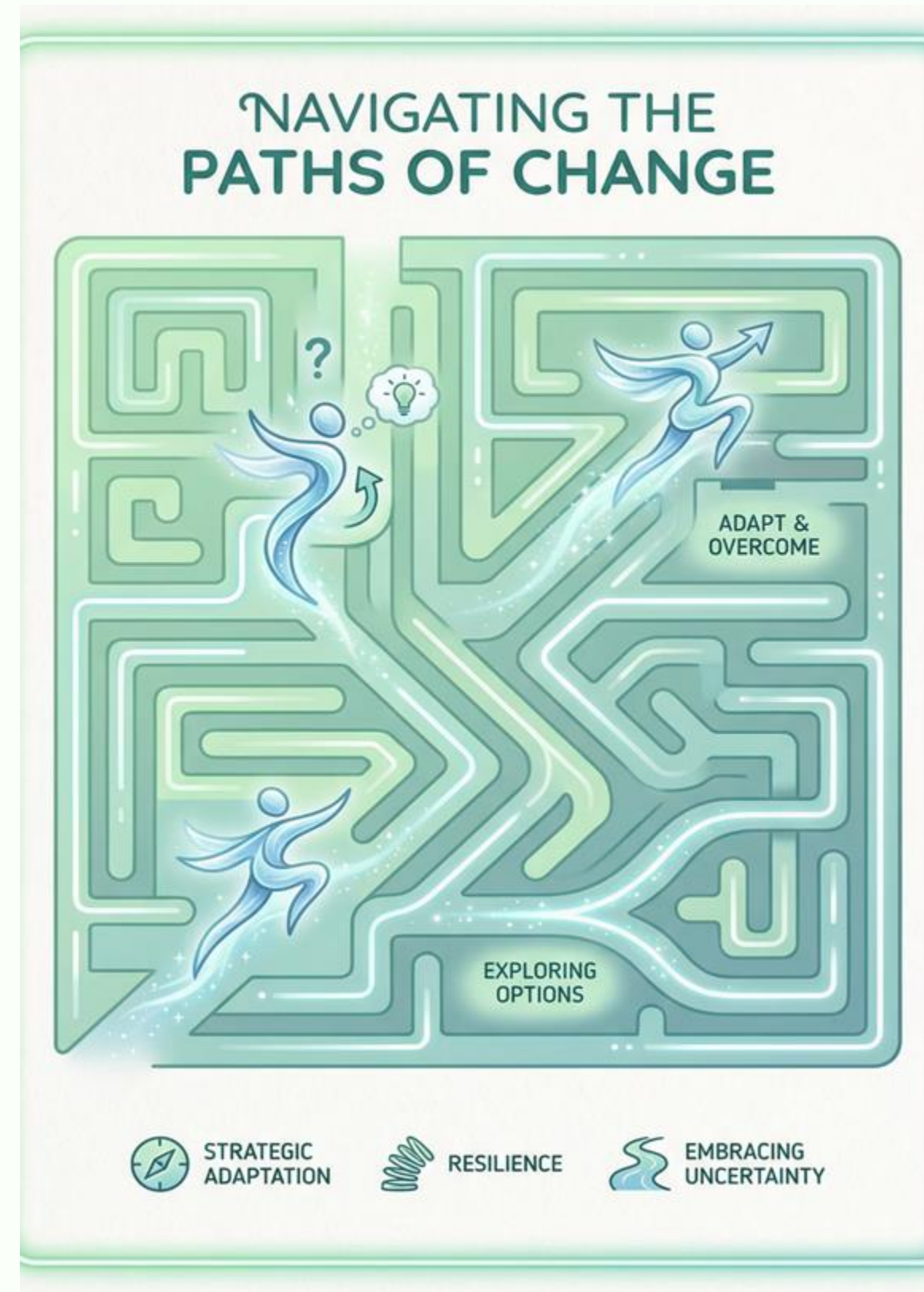
Reality Encountered

- Only obtained partial understanding of the business workflow.
- No access to actual data formats or document examples.
- SETWorks system still under development, limiting testing.
- Original plan for detailed demonstrations could not be achieved.

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Adjusted Direction

- Shifted focus to instructional program guidance.
- Emphasized conceptual explanations and AI application thinking.
- Reframed content away from detailed step-by-step operations.



Key Challenges



Limited Experience

Our team lacked prior experience with Trillium's business operations and product research.



Purpose Misalignment

Different features between AI systems made direct comparisons challenging.



Restricted Data Access

We could not access sample case notes or other critical Trillium documents.



SETWorks Limitations

No account access or sufficient resources for in-depth testing of SETWorks AI.



Communication Coordination

Workflow discovery activities (onsite visits, demonstrations, questionnaires) were canceled to avoid interfering with staff workloads.

Solution & Deliverables: A Strategic Approach

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Solution Approach & Methodology

- **Pain-point Based Approach**
Focus on client's need
- **Functional Comparison**
A discussion of whether each AI tools can help with Trilliums daily task
- **Performance Scoring**
A grading system of the performance of each AI tool for each pain point

2

Justifying Our Design

Why a Pain-Point Approach?

AI tools are focusing on different features and cannot be directly compared

Why not direct LLM comparison?

Client cares about whether AI tools can solve their actual work tasks instead of the computational power.

3

Alternatives Considered

Qualitative Interviews + Quantitative Surveys

Unable to follow initial approach due to client requirements

Demonstration

Pain-point Report

Contents

Trillium Staff Pain Points Report
1. Documentation Overload
2. Administrative Burden from Updates & Compliance
3. Billing & Data Accuracy Challenges.....
4. Inefficient Collaboration & Information Sharing.....
5. System Limitations in SetWorks.....
6. Follow-Up & Compliance Tracking
7. Lack of Automation in Reporting.....

Recommendation Report

Contents

Overview
Functional Comparison.....
1. Language Model Quality.....
2. Integration With Existing Systems
3. Staff Adoption & Training Requirements.....
4. Data Search & Utilization Capability.....
5. Image Generation
6. AI Agent Builder
7. Cost Comparison
8. Vendor Support & Roadmap Alignment
Performance Scoring.....
Conclusion.....
References

Training Plan

Contents

SETWorks AI — Trillium Training & Enablement Plan..
1. Roles & Responsibilities
1.1 Designated AI Specialist.....
1.2 Super Users.....
1.3 General Staff
2. Knowledge Management & Documentation....
2.1 Core Components of the Hub
3. Training Strategy
3.1 Generic Interaction Training
3.2 Train-the-Trainer
4. Deployment Timeline Strategy
4.1 AI Agent Builder (Introduce Immediately)
4.2 Ambient AI (Phase In)
5. Learning Materials & Support.....
6. Measurement & Continuous Improvement.....
7. Kickoff Checklist.....

Technical Implementation: A Robust Framework

Evaluation Implementation

We structured Trillium's pain points into a detailed task-level matrix. Using a 1-5 scoring rubric, we calculated category and overall scores, then estimated potential time savings.



Innovative Approach

We proposed a two-layer AI adoption model (AI Specialist + General Staff) and developed a concept for agent documentation and governance.



Feasibility & Sustainability

The framework uses simple, maintainable tools like spreadsheets and templates. It's reusable for future AI tools and pain points, supporting ongoing, data-driven AI investment and training decisions.



Impact & Value



Client Value

- SETWorks AI can significantly improve staff efficiency by automating repetitive documentation and summarization tasks, allowing teams to focus more on high-value, client-facing work.



Measurable Outcomes

- According to our research, our solution will impact 100% of Trillium's staff and improve the efficiency of over 60% of their current tasks.



Success Metrics

- Project success is defined by the client's satisfaction with the clarity, depth, and practicality of our evaluation report.
- Achievement is demonstrated when Trillium affirms that our conclusions and recommendations effectively address their workflow challenges.



Future Potential

- The next step is leveraging SETWorks AI's AI Agent Builder to create customized chatbots tailored to Trillium's specific administrative workflows.
- Trillium can continue collaborating with SETWorks to provide feedback and influence future product enhancements.

Reflection & Acknowledgments

Team Learning

- We learned that even with limited resources and constraints, effective solutions are still achievable when focusing on structured analysis and clear prioritization.
- Interdisciplinary collaboration broadened the perspectives used to evaluate problems, resulting in more balanced decision-making. Working together and learning step by step provided greater confidence throughout the process.

Acknowledgments



Trillium Employment Services

For their invaluable insights, generous time, and openness throughout our project.



Faculty Advisors & Mentors

For their continuous guidance and support, which significantly strengthened our work's quality and rigor.



Q & A

Appendix I: Time Management

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Appendix I: Time Management

Appendix II: Pain Points

1. Documentation Overload

- **Repeat information:** each case-note needs to have basic information. This can be time consuming, so often staff are rushed and may omit key information, creating challenges in the future when pulling information or time consuming corrections. Could there be AI tools to auto populate things or use @to tag staff or client or business that are already in SETWorks?
- **Tedious Notification Entries:** There are periodic notices that need to go out for all clients (most commonly to DDA). It would be helpful to have an automated system so a human doesn't have to go enter into each client to say "Sent XXX to DDA"
- **Duplicated Data Entry:** The same job placement or client information must be entered into SetWorks, emailed to government partners (e.g., DVR, DDA, counties), and retyped into internal spreadsheets on SharePoint. (SETWorks reporting is not always reliable, so internal spreadsheets are used).

2. Administrative Burden from Updates & Compliance

- **Annual Wage Updates:** Annually, staff manually update wages for all employed clients, researching city/county rules and company size, then verifying with client pay stubs. This process is labor-intensive and error-prone.
- **Employment Plan Distribution:** Signed DVR documents and employment plans must be sent to multiple recipients for every client, creating a heavy clerical load to both submit and document submission in case note
- **Job Placement Tracking:** Employer and wage details are re-entered into multiple formats (SetWorks, government forms, spreadsheets), with updates required whenever wages or job conditions change.

3. Billing & Data Accuracy Challenges

- **Hours Reconciliation:** Staff must manually compare hours logged in SetWorks against county-provided spreadsheets. Discrepancies lead to billing errors, rejected invoices, or lost reimbursements.
- **Case Note Quality Control:** Managers manually audit case notes at month-end to ensure required details are present. Missing data forces rework and slows down reporting.
- **Non-Billable vs. Billable Errors:** Hundreds of case notes marked as non-billable must be reviewed line by line to identify possible misclassified billable activities.

4. Inefficient Collaboration & Information Sharing

- **Meeting Note Taking:** Weekly team meetings rotate notetakers, which takes time and distracts staff from participation.
- **Job Development Leads:** Employer leads are shared verbally or by email, with no automatic linkage to client preferences stored in SetWorks. Opportunities are often missed.
- **Cross-County Visibility:** Job opportunities discovered in one county are not easily shared with other counties, limiting collaboration and client placement options.

Appendix II: Pain Points

5. System Limitations in SetWorks

- **Poor Candidate Search & Matching:** Although SetWorks contains detailed client data (job preferences, hours, commute distance, skills), staff cannot easily query or match this data to new job opportunities. For example, if a restaurant job becomes available, there is no simple way to generate a list of all clients interested in restaurant work nearby.

6. Follow-Up & Compliance Tracking

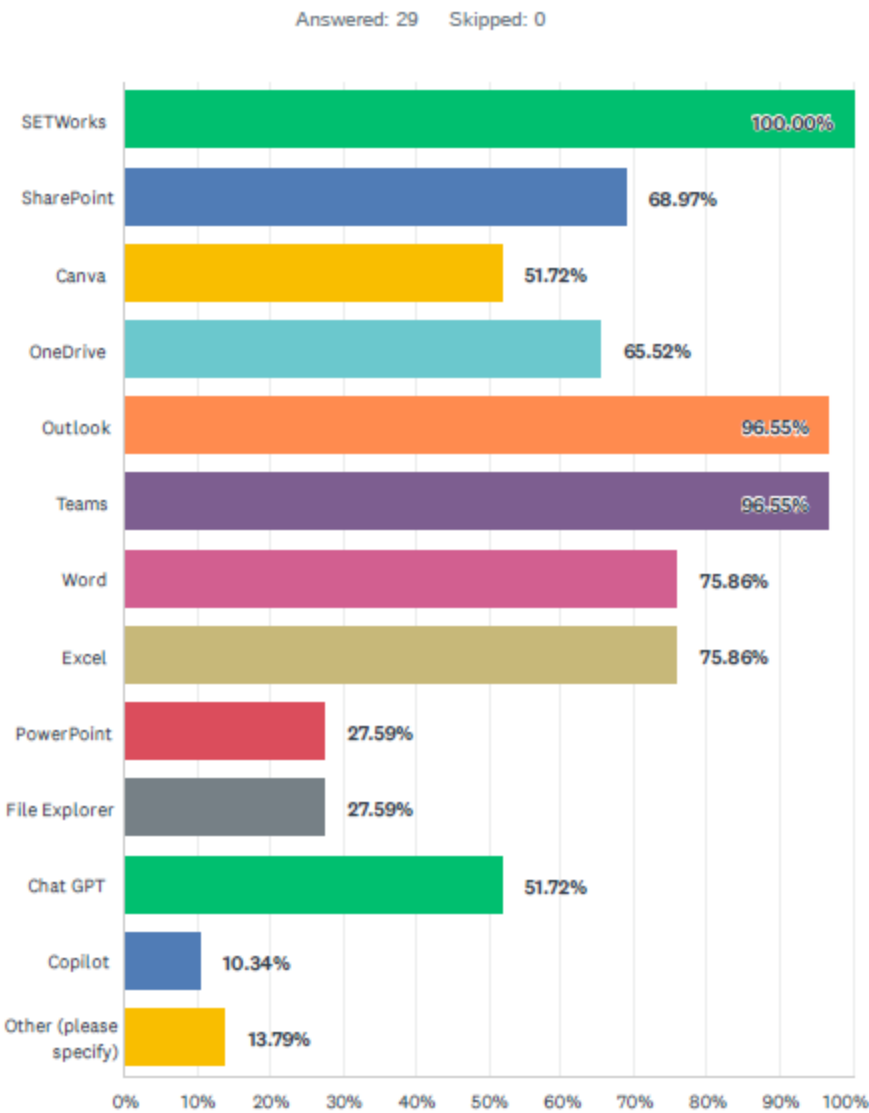
- **Incident Reports:** After filing incident reports, follow-up actions are tracked manually in spreadsheets. Managers must remind staff to complete promised actions, creating delays and oversight risks.
- **Case Note Continuity:** Staff often struggle to recall past client activities when writing new case notes, requiring them to search manually through records for context.

7. Lack of Automation in Reporting

- **Manual Report Creation:** Staff must re-read case notes to draft DVR and School-to-Work reports. These reports require structured formatting and quality checks, creating significant duplication of effort.
- **Limited Database Utility:** While SetWorks holds valuable data, it lacks effective search and matching functions (e.g., automatically linking job openings to clients' job interests), forcing reliance on human memory and meetings.

Appendix III: SETWorks in Trillium

Q1 Which of the following tools do you use regularly in your role? (multi-select)



ANSWER CHOICES	RESPONSES	
SETWorks (1)	100.00%	29
SharePoint (2)	68.97%	20
Canva (3)	51.72%	15
OneDrive (4)	65.52%	19
Outlook (5)	96.55%	28
Teams (6)	96.55%	28
Word (7)	75.86%	22
Excel (8)	75.86%	22
PowerPoint (9)	27.59%	8
File Explorer (10)	27.59%	8
Chat GPT (11)	51.72%	15
Copilot (12)	10.34%	3
Other (please specify) (13)	13.79%	4
Total Respondents: 29		

BASIC STATISTICS				
Minimum	Maximum	Median	Mean	Standard Deviation
1.00	13.00	5.00	5.58	3.18

#	OTHER (PLEASE SPECIFY)	DATE
1	Piktochart	3/5/2025 3:24 PM
2	Piktochart	3/5/2025 3:23 PM
3	Piktochart	3/5/2025 3:23 PM
4	Publisher	3/3/2025 1:06 PM